

Chag HaShavuos

חג השבועות

Na'aseh VeNishma · Shiur Highlights · Social Clips



Four moments from Rabbi Shalom Rosner's Shavuos shiur on Na'aseh VeNishma — curated for short-form video and deep study. From Reb Bunim's question about unity to the nations' terror at Matan Torah, these clips illuminate the singular moment that changed the world forever.

Clip Index

01	shav-naase	0:12	Why did they say WE and not I?
02	shav-water	0:41	The mashal that explains Sinai perfectly
03	shav-mabul	1:31	The nations thought Matan Torah was a FLOOD
04	shav-achdus	2:48	2 types of unity. Only ONE has ever happened.

נַעֲשֶׂה וְנִשְׁמָע

"We will do and we will hear" — Shemos 24:7

כְּאִישׁ אֶחָד בְּלֵב אֶחָד

"As one person with one heart"



Why did they say WE and not I?

Why did they say WE and not I?

Na'aseh VeNishma — Reb Bunim's question.

נַעֲשֶׂה וְנִשְׁמָע

"We will do and we will hear" — Shemos 24:7

Reb Bunim of Peshischa noticed a grammatical impossibility in the famous words of Kabbalas HaTorah. "Na'aseh VeNishma" — we will do and we will hear — uses plural (rabbim). But how did everyone know what everyone else was thinking? How could they speak with one voice before any vote was taken? The answer: when the revelation is overwhelming, unanimity is not discussion — it is recognition. They didn't vote; they simply all saw the same thing at the same moment.

"It was so clear. There was a clarity of vision of the revelation of the Kadosh Baruch Hu."

Closing card quote:

"At Sinai the clarity was so overwhelming and so shared that the response could only be: WE."



The mashal that explains Sinai perfectly.**The mashal that explains Sinai perfectly.**

Prisoners. No water. Days go by.

נַעֲשֶׂה וְנִשְׁמָע - לְשׁוֹן רַבִּים

"We will do and hear — the plural is the whole point"

Reb Bunim's mashal: a group of prisoners denied water for days. When the warden finally offers water, do they say "I'll take some, but I'm not sure about the other guys"? Impossible. They cry together: WE want water! The shared experience of deprivation created collective desire — desire so obvious that no vote is needed, no consultation required. At Sinai, the shared experience of divine revelation created collective commitment in exactly the same way.

"We all want water! When you're truly thirsty, the word 'I' disappears."

Closing card quote:

"When you're truly thirsty, you don't say 'I'll take some.' You say WE all want water."



The nations thought Matan Torah was a FLOOD.

The nations thought Matan Torah was a FLOOD.

And they weren't entirely wrong.

ה' עז לעמו יתן

"Hashem gives strength to His people" — Tehillim 29:11

The Gemara in Zevachim 116a records that when the nations heard the thunder and lightning of Matan Torah, they ran to Bilam HaRasha in terror: "Is there another Mabul?" They had never seen this type of unity — אחד בלב אחד כאיש — and the only precedent they could recall for such overwhelming force was the Teiva. Bilam corrected them: this is not a flood of water; this is 'ה' — יתן לעמו עוז — Hashem gives strength to His people. What they witnessed was not destruction. It was creation.

"They saw a unity they could not comprehend — and feared the world was ending."

Closing card quote:

"They saw a unity they couldn't understand — so they thought the world was ending."



There are 2 types of unity. Only ONE has ever happened.

**There are 2 types of unity.
Only ONE has ever happened.**

כְּאִישׁ אֶחָד בְּלֵב אֶחָד

"As one person with one heart" — Rashi, Shemos 19:2

Rav Meir Shapiro identifies two fundamentally different types of Achdus. Type 1: unity from necessity — ברירה אין מתוך אחדות — as on the Teiva, where animals cooperated purely to survive. This unity dissolves the moment necessity does. Type 2: unity from shared vision — מתוך אחדות משותף חזון — as at Har Sinai, where Am Yisrael stood together not from fear but from shared recognition of divine truth. Yeshayahu's vision of the messianic era describes Type 2 returning to the world permanently.

אחד בלב אחד — *as one person with one heart. Not because they had no choice. Because they saw the same thing.*

Closing card quote:

"Unity from necessity fades. Unity from shared vision — אחד בלב אחד — that changes the world."

